

countries, though much of the manufacturing of the signalling equipment was in-house.



▲ Railway lantern

Early equipment

The earliest signalling equipment used on the railways in India were revolving discs or rectangular boards or semaphore signals with arms fixed on top of a pole, which were manually operated by a lever at the foot of the pole. In a lower quadrant type semaphore signal, which was widely used, a lowered arm meant that the line was clear and raised indicated danger. Separate red and green spectacles were provided for lights for the night to indicate whether there was danger ahead or the track was clear.

While signals were erected at various locations across the network, the platform outside the station master's office had "main" or "home" signals, which consisted of two more arms on either side of the pole. Others such as "outer" or "distant" signals, which had square-ended